

**AKENTEN APPIAH-MENKA UNIVERSITY OF SKILLS
TRAINING AND ENTREPRENEURIAL DEVELOPMENT
(AAMUSTED)**

FACULTY OF BUSINESS EDUCATION

**STANDARDIZED POLICY GUIDELINES FOR
UNDERGRADUATE PROJECT WRITING**

2026

OVERVIEW

The document titled “Standardized Policy Guidelines for Undergraduate Project Writing” is a proposed policy framework developed by the Faculty of Business Education (FBE), Akenten Appiah-Menka University of Skills Training and Entrepreneurial Development (AAMUSTED). The guidelines were developed by a Faculty Committee on Undergraduate Research and Project Standardization to harmonize undergraduate project writing, supervision, and assessment practices.

The primary objective of the committee was to ensure consistency, academic rigor, ethical compliance, and alignment with both local and international best practices in undergraduate research. In developing the document, the committee conducted a thorough review of undergraduate project policies and practices across reputable universities in Ghana and abroad, including benchmark institutions that operate group-based projects, practice-oriented research, and innovation-driven undergraduate capstone models.

The policy clearly articulates the purpose and scope of undergraduate project work as a core academic requirement aimed at developing students’ research competence, critical thinking, analytical skills, and professional problem-solving abilities. It aligns undergraduate research practices with national policy frameworks such as Supported Teaching in School (STS), T-TEL reforms, and the National Teachers’ Standards, while also reflecting internationally accepted undergraduate research norms.

The document defines approved types of undergraduate projects, including Post-STS Action Research for education-focused programmes, Traditional Research Projects, and Innovative and Design Projects for non-education programmes. It provides structured chapter formats for each project type, clear formatting and referencing rules (APA 7th edition), ethical and plagiarism requirements, and standardized printing and submission procedures.

Overall, this policy document represents a significant quality-assurance initiative by the Faculty of Business Education. It provides a clear, student-friendly, and enforceable framework that strengthens academic integrity, supports supervisors, and ensures that undergraduate research at AAMUSTED meets both national relevance and global academic standards.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

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1.0 INTRODUCTION

The undergraduate project is a core academic requirement for students in the Faculty of Business Education (FBE), designed to develop scholarly competence, professional relevance, and ethical research practice. Its primary purpose is to equip students with the knowledge, skills, and intellectual discipline required to apply business and educational theories to real-world problems through systematic inquiry. The undergraduate project trains students in critical thinking, independent judgment, data collection and analysis, and responsible reporting of findings, while encouraging the application of knowledge for the improvement of business education and society at large.

All undergraduate projects shall include a clearly defined research problem, objectives, methodology, findings, conclusions, and recommendations, and shall be written in clear academic English. The project shall be undertaken under the supervision of a qualified academic staff member and must demonstrate originality, logical coherence, and adherence to approved ethical and academic standards.

1.1 Undergraduate Project Work

Undergraduate Project Work is a compulsory academic requirement designed to develop students' research competence, critical thinking, and professional problem-solving skills. In developing this harmonized guideline for the Faculty of Business Education (FBE), the committee conducted a thorough review of undergraduate research standards and practices across leading local and international universities, including institutions in Africa, Europe, North America, Asia, and Australia. This benchmarking ensured that the structure, content, and assessment of undergraduate project work are globally competitive while remaining locally relevant.

The guideline aligns with international best practices in undergraduate research, such as those advocated by the Council on Undergraduate Research (CUR), which emphasizes inquiry-based learning, ethical conduct, originality, and structured supervision (Lopatto, 2010; Healey & Jenkins, 2009). It also reflects standards commonly used in reputable universities where undergraduate research focuses on clearly defined problems, appropriate methodology, valid data analysis, and coherent reporting (Creswell & Creswell, 2018; Saunders et al., 2019).

At the local and national level, the guideline is aligned with Ghana's teacher education reforms, particularly the policies and frameworks promoted by T-TEL, the National Teachers' Standards

for Ghana (Ministry of Education, 2017), and the Supported Teaching in School (STS) framework. These standards emphasize reflective practice, evidence-based decision-making, ethical research conduct, and the integration of theory and practice. By harmonizing global and local standards, the undergraduate project work ensures that FBE graduates are well prepared for professional practice, postgraduate studies, and lifelong learning in business and education.

2.0 SUPERVISION AND PROGRESSION OF PROJECT

The undergraduate research project shall be carried out in a systematic, progressive, and closely supervised manner to ensure academic quality, originality, and timely completion. The project is intended to guide students through the practical application of research skills under the direct supervision of an assigned academic supervisor.

Throughout the project period, supervisors shall provide continuous guidance and monitor students' progress through regular consultations and review of submitted drafts. Departments may, where necessary, conduct periodic progress checks to ensure that students are receiving appropriate supervision and are complying strictly with the approved undergraduate project guidelines.

This progression framework is consistent with widely accepted undergraduate research practices in reputable universities globally and is designed to strengthen students' research competence, analytical thinking, and academic writing skills within the context of Business Education.

2.1 Presentation and Submission of the Undergraduate Project Report

- a) The undergraduate project report shall be written in clear, coherent, and formal academic English. It shall include an abstract of not more than one page, summarizing the background of the study, problem statement, objectives, methodology, key findings, conclusions, and recommendations.
- b) The project report shall represent the student's independent scholarly work, carried out under the guidance of an assigned supervisor. The supervisor shall be responsible for guiding the student to comply strictly with the approved guidelines and for certifying that the final work meets the required academic and ethical standards.

- c) In line with international undergraduate research standards, the length of the project report shall normally fall within the following range, excluding preliminary pages and appendices:
 - i. Minimum: 8,000 words (approximately 40 pages)
 - ii. Maximum: 15,000 words (approximately 60–70 pages)
- d) This range reflects common undergraduate project requirements in education, business, and social science programmes worldwide and ensures adequate depth without imposing postgraduate-level demands on students.
- e) A student shall not submit a project report that has previously been used to obtain an academic qualification in this or any other institution. Where portions of previous coursework or assignments are incorporated, such material shall be clearly acknowledged and properly referenced.
- f) The final project report shall be accompanied by signed declaration statements by the student, and the supervisor confirming the originality of the work and that it has not been submitted elsewhere for assessment.
- g) Any project report found to contain false declarations, plagiarism, or serious academic misconduct shall be disqualified, irrespective of the stage of assessment.
- h) Students shall submit a final electronic (PDF) copy of the approved project report to the Head of Department or through an officially designated submission platform.
- i) Undergraduate project work shall be examined and graded solely by the assigned supervisor, in accordance with the approved Faculty assessment criteria.
- j) Upon successful assessment and incorporation of required corrections, students shall submit a final bound hard copy and an electronic copy of the project report before graduation. Departments may additionally require students to present their project findings through a seminar or poster presentation to promote academic communication and professional confidence.

3.0 TYPES OF UNDERGRADUATE RESEARCH PROJECTS

Undergraduate students shall undertake research projects that are aligned with their programme focus, learning outcomes, and professional orientation. In recognition of current practices in reputable universities locally and internationally, including the use of collaborative undergraduate research projects, the Faculty of Business Education adopts the following approved categories of undergraduate research projects.

3.1 Supported Teaching in School (STS) – Post-STS (Action Research)

All B.Ed. students and students pursuing education-focused programmes shall compulsorily undertake Supported Teaching in School (STS) – Post-STS Action Research as their undergraduate research project. This project shall be conducted individually, given its classroom-based, reflective, and practice-oriented nature. Students are required to identify a real instructional problem during their STS placement, implement an appropriate intervention, and evaluate its impact through systematic action research.

3.2 Traditional Research Project

Students pursuing non-education or non-teaching-focused programmes within the faculty shall undertake a traditional undergraduate research project. This type of project may be conducted individually or in groups, with a maximum group size of five (5) students, consistent with practices in other local and global institutions.

Traditional research projects may include descriptive, survey, correlational, qualitative, case study, or mixed-methods research, provided the scope and methodology are appropriate for undergraduate level. Where group projects are undertaken, each student's role and contribution must be clearly defined, documented, and assessed by the supervisor to ensure fairness and accountability.

3.3 Innovative and Design Project

Alternatively, students may undertake an Innovative and Design Project, which focuses on the development of practical solutions, systems, models, prototypes, or business innovations. This project type shall be conducted in groups of not more than five (5) students and must demonstrate originality, creativity, and practical relevance. Individual contributions shall be clearly specified and evaluated.

3.4 General Requirements

All students shall comply strictly with the approved Faculty guidelines for undergraduate project work. Supervisors shall guide students in selecting an appropriate project type and ensure that project execution, documentation, and assessment meet approved academic, ethical, and professional standards. Group-based projects shall include mechanisms for tracking individual contributions to ensure transparency and equity in assessment.

4.0 FORMAT OF THE UNDERGRADUATE PROJECT REPORT

The undergraduate project report is a compulsory academic requirement for the award of a bachelor's degree in the Faculty of Business Education. No undergraduate degree shall be awarded until all approved requirements relating to the preparation, presentation, and submission of the project report have been satisfactorily met. The project report shall demonstrate the student's ability to conduct systematic inquiry, apply appropriate research methods, and communicate findings clearly and ethically.

An undergraduate project report shall consist of three main components, namely:

- (a) the preliminary pages,
- (b) the main body of the report, and
- (c) the appendices.

4.1 PRELIMINARY PAGES

The preliminary section of the undergraduate project report shall include the following, arranged in the order specified:

4.1.1 Spine

The spine of the bound project report shall display, in horizontal order, the degree programme, the full name of the student, and the year of submission. These elements shall be printed clearly and legibly.

Example format:

The Spine of Rabiatsu Idan Faya's B.Ed. project work shall appear as follows:

B.Ed. RABIATU IDAN FAYA 2026

The Spine of Prince Atsu Gyimah's BSc. project work shall appear as follows:

BSc. PRINCE ATSU GYIMAH 2026

The Spine of Kwame Danquah Acheampong's BBA. project work shall appear as follows:

BBA. KWAME DANQUAH ACHEAMPONG 2026

4.1.2 Outside Cover

The outside cover shall contain four key blocks of information, arranged vertically and centered on the page:

1. The full name of the University at the top of the page.
2. The title of the undergraduate project.
3. The full name of the student (without titles).
4. The year of submission.

Titles such as Mr., Mrs., Ms., Rev., etc. shall not appear on the outside cover.

Example format:

**AKENTEN APPIAH-MENKA UNIVERSITY OF SKILLS TRAINING AND
ENTREPRENEURIAL DEVELOPMENT**

**DETERMINANTS OF SUSTAINABILITY PRACTICES AMONG SMALL
BUSINESSES IN GHANA**

PRINCE ATSU GYIMAH

2026

4.1.3 Title Page (Inside Cover)

The title page shall be the first page of the preliminary section and shall contain the following information, presented in clearly separated blocks:

- The full name of the University
- The title of the project report
- The full name of the student and index number
- A statement indicating the Department and Faculty to which the project is submitted and the degree programme for which it is required
- The month and year of submission

Although the title page forms part of the preliminary pages, it shall not carry a printed page number.

Example format:

**AKENTEN APPIAH-MENKA UNIVERSITY OF SKILLS TRAINING AND
ENTREPRENEURIAL DEVELOPMENT**

**DETERMINANTS OF SUSTAINABILITY PRACTICES AMONG SMALL
BUSINESSES IN GHANA**

BY

**PRINCE ATSU GYIMAH
(5261010001)**

**Research Project (or Action Research or Innovative and Design Project)* submitted to
the Department of Accounting Studies Education in the Faculty of Business Education,
Akenten Appiah-Menka University of Skills Training and Entrepreneurial Development
in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the award of a Bachelor of Science in
Accounting.**

NOVEMBER 2026

*Choose the type of research project conducted. Also, 'BY' can be used here; however, titles such as Mr., Mrs., Ms., Rev., etc. are still not acceptable.

4.1.4 Declaration Page

The declaration page shall confirm the originality and authenticity of the project work. It shall be divided into two parts:

- Student's Declaration, affirming that the work is original and has not been submitted elsewhere for academic credit
- Supervisor's Declaration, confirming that the project was carried out under approved supervision and in line with Faculty guidelines

Both declarations shall be duly signed and dated.

Example format:

DECLARATION

Candidate's Declaration

I hereby declare that this project, with the exception of quotations and references contained in published works which have been duly acknowledged, is the result of my own original work and that no part of it has been presented for another degree at this university or elsewhere.

Candidate's Name:

Signature: Date:

Supervisor's Declaration

I hereby declare that the preparation and presentation of this project were supervised in accordance with guidelines on supervision of project works laid down by the Akenten Appiah-Menka University of Skills Training and Entrepreneurial Development.

Supervisor's Name:

Signature: Date:

4.1.5 Acknowledgements

This section allows the student to formally recognize individuals and institutions that provided academic, professional, or logistical support during the conduct of the project. These may include supervisors, lecturers, organizations, and colleagues.

4.1.6 Dedication

The dedication, where included, shall be brief and concise. It should not exceed a few lines and should not duplicate acknowledgements.

4.1.7 Table of Contents

The table of contents shall list all chapters, sections, and sub-sections in the report, together with their corresponding page numbers. Chapter titles shall be written in uppercase and bold type, while subheadings shall appear in title case and bolded.

4.1.8 List of Tables, Figures, and Acronyms

Where applicable, separate lists of tables and figures shall be provided, indicating their titles and page numbers. A list of acronyms or abbreviations may also be included if such terms are used extensively in the report.

4.1.9 Ethical Clearance (Where Applicable)

If the undergraduate project involves human participants, organizations, or sensitive data, evidence of ethical approval or informed consent shall be included as part of the preliminary pages, in accordance with University and Faculty ethical guidelines.

4.1.10 Use of Editorial Assistance (If Applicable)

Where professional editorial assistance has been obtained, the student shall include a brief statement identifying the nature of the assistance received. Such assistance shall be limited to language, formatting, and presentation and shall not alter the intellectual content of the project.

4.1.11 Confidentiality Statement (If Applicable)

Where a project contains confidential information for academic, institutional, or commercial reasons, a separate confidentiality statement shall be included, clearly identifying the nature of the confidential material and the conditions under which access may be restricted.

All undergraduate project reports shall adhere strictly to this approved format. Students are required to comply fully with these guidelines, and supervisors are responsible for guiding students to ensure strict adherence throughout the preparation, submission, and assessment of the project.

5.0 ABSTRACT

The abstract is a brief and complete summary of the undergraduate project and provides readers with a clear overview of the entire study. It should clearly present the main problem investigated, the purpose and objectives of the study, the research approach or methodology used, the key findings, and the main conclusions and recommendations. The abstract allows readers to quickly understand what the study is about without reading the full report.

For undergraduate projects, the abstract should be written as one well-developed paragraph and should normally range between 200 and 300 words, but must not exceed one page. It should be written after completing the entire project, even though it appears at the beginning of the report. This helps ensure that all important aspects of the study are accurately captured.

Students should write the abstract in clear and simple academic language, avoiding unnecessary details. It should not include symbols, tables, figures, references, abbreviations, or highly

technical terms, except in rare cases where they are essential to understanding the study. The abstract should be factual and objective, focusing on what was done and what was found, rather than personal opinions. In summary, a good abstract gives a concise but complete picture of the study and should enable any reader to understand the scope, method, and outcomes of the undergraduate project at a glance.

6.0 MAIN TEXT

6.1 SUPPORTED TEACHING IN SCHOOL - POST STS (ACTION RESEARCH)

Action research is a systematic, reflective inquiry conducted by a teacher to identify a real classroom problem, implement a targeted intervention, and evaluate its impact on teaching and learning using evidence from practice.

It is recommended that the Post STS (Action Research) be compulsory for all B.Ed. students and students pursuing education-related programmes in the Faculty of Business Education (FBE) to ensure that graduates are not only content-competent but also capable of improving learner outcomes through evidence-based decision-making. This requirement aligns strongly with Ghana's teacher education reforms led by T-TEL, the National Teachers' Standards, and the Supported Teaching in School (STS) framework, which emphasize reflective practice, learner-centred pedagogy, and continuous school improvement. Internationally, action research is widely recognised as a core professional skill that bridges theory and practice, promotes inclusive education, and prepares teachers to respond effectively to diverse classroom challenges, making it a globally relevant and policy-consistent component of teacher education.

The topic should be derived from a clearly identified classroom problem and the intervention intended to address it. Action research topics should reflect both the problem and the solution.

6.1.1 Proposed Format for Writing a Classroom Inquiry (Action Research) Report

CHAPTER ONE: INTRODUCTION

1.0 Introduction

Provide a short introduction for chapter one.

Maximum of 100 words and at most 1/3 of a page.

1.1 Background to the Study

This section should provide a contextual introduction to the study and include:

- How the classroom problem was identified. The identification should be backed by current literature and students must include citations in their writings.
- Evidence of the existence of the problem (e.g. pre-intervention class exercises, quizzes, tests, observations, or assessments).
- Diagnosis of the problem.
- Description of the study area (school, class, subject, and learner characteristics).

The background of the study section should not exceed three pages.

1.2 Statement of the Problem

Provide a clear and concise description of the specific classroom problem observed during teaching practice. Students should try to:

- Identify the gaps. What is trending, known, and unknown in the specific classroom problem you have identified.
- Briefly describe your concern. That is, conditions in your classroom that you are not happy about and which you want to change.
- State the evidence and the causes of the problem (i.e. How did you know that certain things are not going on well in your classroom? What are the causes?).
- At most the Statement of the problem should not go beyond 2 pages.

1.3 Purpose of the Study

The overall aim of the study, clearly indicating the intended change or improvement.

1.4 Objectives of the Study

- List the specific objectives the study seeks to achieve. They are the outcomes you want to achieve for doing the study.
- Minimum of two and Maximum of 5 specific objectives and should focus on relevant, useful and important objectives.

1.5 Research Questions

Questions guiding the action research.

- Rewrite your specific objectives into questions using the words “what”, and “how”.

- Note that your first research objective should be converted to question tag for the first research question, and in that order. Thus, if your research objectives are three; then your research questions should also be three.

1.6 Significance of the Study

- Identify interested stakeholders of your research and provide the benefits they would gain from the study's findings.
- Put differently, state the benefits of the study to various users of your report. Indicate how the results of the study would be beneficial to each user group.
- Show how the results will improve teaching and learning, and a few contributions to theory and practice.
- Significance of the study should not go beyond 2 pages.

1.7 Delimitations/Scope of the Study

The boundaries of the study in terms of location, participants, content, and duration.

- Focus on the justification of the choice of the case study or survey, and the main themes as captured by the research objectives/questions.
- Briefly explain the scope of the study (i.e. the restrictions you placed on the coverage of the study).
- Normally, your sampling frame and the specific objectives of the study delimit the study's scope.
- Delimitations/Scope of the study should not go beyond a page.

1.8 Limitations of the Study

Challenges encountered during the study and how they affected the research.

- Explain the problems encountered during the interventions and how they were overcome.
- Provide the potential weaknesses of the study in relation to how you selected the samples, the instruments you used to collect data, how you actually collected data, and how you analysed that data.
- NOTE: Time and resources constraints are not limitation.
- Limitations of the study should not go beyond a page.

1.9 Definition of Key Terms

- Give key definitions used in your work. You can concentrate on key variables in the research objectives.
- Define any term that you have used in a special way. Do not write dictionary or encyclopedia definitions.
- Full words of abbreviations are also not definitions of terms.
- Definition of key terms should not go beyond a page.

1.10 Organization/Structure of the Study

Briefly describe the structure of the entire project. Half a page is okay.

NB: Chapter one total pages should be between 9 and 12 pages. Students should take note of this.

CHAPTER TWO: LITERATURE REVIEW

2.0 Introduction

Restate the purpose of the study as you stated in chapter one. Then, briefly describe the content of the chapter. Maximum of 100 words and at most 1/3 of a page.

2.1 Conceptual Review

Concept is a general idea or an understanding about something.

- Briefly explain the relevant concepts related to the problem and intervention.
- Focus on the key concepts or variables in your study.
- Group the review of the concepts under suitable headings. Thus, if you have four key concepts in the topic or research objectives, you will have sections 2.1.1, 2.1.2, 2.1.3, and 2.1.4.
- It is recommended that the pages of your conceptual review should not go beyond 10 pages.

2.2 Theoretical Review

Theory is a general principle explaining a phenomenon. It is scientifically credible.

- Briefly review the theories on which the study is based. Note that the theories should be relevant learning or teaching theories underpinning the study.

- Review only those theories that relate to the specific objectives. At this level, provide at most two theories.
- Group the review under suitable headings. If you use two theories, the subsections will be 2.2.1 and 2.2.2. Your last paragraph of each theory should justify why they are important to your research objectives.
- Use paragraph headings for each study that you have reviewed.
- Theoretical review should not go beyond five pages.

2.3 Empirical Review

Review of related studies relevant to the problem and intervention.

- Briefly review actual studies related to the topic. Note that you need to search and provide at least fifteen (15) studies in the last five years (at least three studies for each year in the last five years) that relate to the specific objectives. You can use Google Scholar (scholar.google.com) or any relevant research search engine to search your topic to identify any prior studies relating to your topic.
- Use paragraph headings for each study that you have reviewed.
- Empirical review should not go beyond five pages.

2.4 Conceptual Framework

- Based on the conceptual, empirical and theoretical reviews done above, students should develop, adopt or adapt a diagram to represent the conceptual framework/model.
- The framework/model should indicate how the study intends to achieve its objectives.
- The framework and brief discussions should not more than two pages.

2.5 Chapter Summary

In half page or a page, provide the key issues emerging from the literature.

NB: Chapter two total pages should be between 15 and 25 pages. Students should take note of this.

CHAPTER THREE: METHODOLOGY

3.0 Introduction

Restate the purpose of the study as you stated in chapter one. Then, briefly describe the content of the chapter. Maximum of 100 words and at most 1/3 of a page.

3.1 Research Design

Briefly describe research design (cite). At most two definitions (cite).

- Give reasons or justification for using the following:
- Set 1 – the design type that can be either exploratory, descriptive or explanatory.
- Set 2 – describe the type of action research design adopted.
- Set 3 – What method did you use – quantitative, qualitative, mixed
- Set 4 – What is your time dimension; cross sectional, longitudinal, etc.

Research design section should not be more than two pages. Be brief and go straight to the point.

3.2 Population of the Study

- Briefly describe population (cite). At most two definitions.
- Describe in detail the population of the study (e.g. total number of students in your class, average age of students in your class, gender distribution of students etc.). Thus, be specific on your population and population size.
- The page for the population of the study should be half or at most one page.

3.3 Sample Size and Sampling Technique

- Briefly describe Sample and Sampling technique(cite).
- Justify how participants or respondents were selected. You can use appropriate formula if you want or other description.
- Provide the response rate and give reasons for using a particular selection (sampling) technique.
- Mention the sample size and its composition (e.g. total number of respondents who took part in the study, gender distribution of respondents who took part in the study, etc.). Thus, provide just one Table 3.1 showing the respondents/participants/sample statistics. Present it here and do not present at Chapter Four.
- The page for the sample size and sampling technique should not go beyond 4 pages.

3.4 Data Collection Instruments

- Give a detailed description of each instrument that you used to collect data (cite). Eg. Example: 3.4.1 Observation, 3.4.2 Interview guide, 3.4.3 Document analysis, 3.4.4 Tests/class exercises, etc.
- Describe each instrument under suitable headings.

- Use paragraph headings when describing the instruments.

3.5 Action Intervention Activities

Action intervention activities should not be more than three pages.

3.5.1 Pre-Intervention Activities

Description of baseline data collection and analysis.

3.5.2 Intervention

- Step-by-step description of the intervention.
- Duration/period of implementation.

3.5.3 Post-Intervention Activities

- Description of post-intervention data collection.
- Conducting post-intervention class exercises, tests, etc. and marking. Examination of marked post-intervention class exercises, tests, etc. and collating results and presenting
- Step-by-step of how you will administer and mark the post-intervention exercises/tests.
How will you present and analyze the post-intervention results?

3.5.4 Comparison of Pre- and Post-Intervention Results

How will you interpret changes observed.

3.6 Data collection Procedures

- Give a detailed description, under suitable headings, of how you used each instrument to collect data (cite).
- Give reasons for using those data collection procedures.
- Use paragraph headings when explaining how you collected data using the instruments.
- A page is okay for data collection procedures.

3.7 Data Analysis

Give a brief overview of how you presented and analyzed your results in chapter four in half a page.

3.8 Data Validity and Reliability

Give a brief overview of how you test the validity and reliability of the responses gathered from teachers and students. At most a page or two pages is recommended to write the data validity and reliability. If any, provide Table 3.2 for the results of validity and reliability of data used for the study.

3.9 Ethical Requirement

Provide the ethics used to conduct the study. State the reference number of the ethical clearance form approved for conduct of the study.

3.10 Profile of the School or College

Give a brief profile of the school or organization if you undertook an action research or case study. It is suggested that at most two pages should be used to write the brief profile.

3.11 Chapter Summary

NB: Chapter Three total pages should be between 12 and 20 pages. Students should take note of this.

CHAPTER FOUR: RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

4.0 Introduction

Restate the purpose of the study as you stated in chapter one. Then, briefly describe the content of the chapter. Maximum of 100 words and at most 1/3 of a page.

4.1 Pre-Intervention Results

- Group and present the pre-intervention results according to the research questions.
- Briefly describe the tables and figures that contain your results.
- Your headings must correspond with those that you used in chapter two for the literature review of actual studies.

4.2 Mid-Intervention Results

- Provide mid-intervention results. Note that this is not compulsory. Students can go ahead and present the post-intervention results in 4.2.

4.3 Post-Intervention Results

- Group and present the post-intervention results according to the research questions.
- Briefly describe the tables and figures that contain your results.
- Your headings must correspond with those that you used in chapter two for the review of actual studies.

4.4 Comparing Post and Pre-intervention results and interpretation

- Use line graph or other pictorial graphs comparing the pre- and post-interventions results.
- Provide the interpretations and reasons for the results.

4.5 Discussion of Results

- Group and discuss the post-intervention results according to the research questions.
- Relate the discussions to the literature reviewed in chapter two.
- Your headings must correspond with those that you used in chapter two for the review of actual studies.

4.6 Chapter Summary

NB: Chapter four total pages should be between 15 and 25 pages. Students should take note of this.

CHAPTER FIVE: SUMMARY, CONCLUSION AND RECOMMENDATIONS

5.0 Introduction

Restate the purpose of the study as you stated in chapter one. Then, briefly describe the content of the chapter. Maximum of 100 words and at most 1/3 of a page.

5.1 Summary of Findings

- Provide a summary of the entire study: the problem, the themes upon which you developed the literature review, the methodology and the findings.
- Provide sub-sections for each objective and provide the summary of the findings. Thus, if you have three objectives, there will be three sub-sections: 5.1.1, 5.1.2, and 5.1.3.

5.2 Conclusion

Tie the conclusions to the findings and the theoretical framework you covered in chapter two.

5.3 Recommendations

Suggestions for teachers, schools, institutions, etc. Thus, suggest actions that people in authority should take based on the findings in chapter four.

5.4 Reflection (Compulsory for STS)

Provide what you gained such as deeper understanding of learners' needs, improved classroom management skills, and developed confidence in reflective teaching.

5.5 Suggestions for Further Research

Suggest possible areas of your topic that you did not investigate for future research by others.

5.6 Chapter Summary

NB: Chapter five total pages should be between 7 and 10 pages. Students should take note of this.

6.2 TRADITIONAL RESEARCH PROJECT (UNDERGRADUATE)

Having provided a detailed explanation and full writing guidelines for Supported Teaching in School (STS) – Post STS (Action Research), this section presents the format for the Traditional Research Project for undergraduate students. To avoid unnecessary repetition, only the main chapter headings and essential subheadings are outlined here. Students are expected to apply the general writing principles, page limits, academic standards, and formatting rules already discussed in the earlier sections of this handbook.

The Traditional Research Project is suitable for non-education students and for programmes where research focuses on describing, explaining, or analyzing phenomena rather than implementing classroom interventions. Such projects may be conducted individually or in groups, in line with approved Faculty guidelines.

6.2.1 Proposed Format for Traditional Undergraduate Research Project

CHAPTER ONE: INTRODUCTION

- 1.0 Introduction
- 1.1 Background to the Study
- 1.2 Statement of the Problem
- 1.3 Purpose of the Study
- 1.4 Research Objectives of the Study
- 1.5 Research Questions and/or Hypotheses (where applicable)
- 1.6 Significance of the Study
- 1.7 Scope / Delimitation of the Study
- 1.8 Limitations of the Study
- 1.9 Definition of Key Terms
- 1.10 Organization of the Study

CHAPTER TWO: LITERATURE REVIEW

- 2.0 Introduction
- 2.1 Conceptual Review
- 2.2 Theoretical Review
- 2.3 Empirical Review
- 2.4 Conceptual Framework (where applicable)
- 2.5 Chapter Summary

CHAPTER THREE: METHODOLOGY

- 3.0 Introduction
- 3.1 Research Design
- 3.2 Study Area (where applicable)
- 3.3 Population of the Study
- 3.4 Sample Size and Sampling Technique
- 3.5 Data Collection Instruments
- 3.6 Data Collection Procedures
- 3.7 Data Analysis Techniques
 - 3.7.1 Model Specification (if applicable, for eg., regression)
 - 3.7.2 Measures of Variables (if applicable)
 - 3.7.3 Estimation Technique/ Strategy (if applicable)

- 3.8 Validity and Reliability
- 3.9 Ethical Considerations
- 3.10 Chapter Summary

CHAPTER FOUR: RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

- 4.0 Introduction
- 4.1 Descriptive Statistics of Participants/Respondents/Sample
- 4.2 Validity and Reliability Tests
- 4.3 Descriptive Statistics of Variable/Constructs
 - 4.3.1 Heading for Research Objective/Hypothesis/Theme/Interview 1
 - 4.3.2 Heading for Research Objective/Hypothesis/Theme/Interview 2
 - 4.3.3 Heading for Research Objective/Hypothesis/Theme/Interview 3, etc.
- 4.4 Regression Results (if applicable)
 - 4.4.1 Heading for Results in line with Research Objective/Hypothesis/Theme/Interview 1
 - 4.4.2 Heading for Results in line with Research Objective/Hypothesis/Theme/Interview 2
 - 4.4.3 Heading for Results in line with Research Objective/Hypothesis/Theme/Interview 3.
- 4.5 Discussion of Results
- 4.6 Chapter Summary

CHAPTER FIVE: SUMMARY, CONCLUSIONS AND RECOMMENDATIONS

- 5.0 Introduction
- 5.1 Summary of Findings
- 5.2 Conclusions
- 5.3 Recommendations
- 5.4 Suggestions for Further Research
- 5.5 Chapter Summary

6.3 INNOVATIVE AND DESIGN PROJECT (UNDERGRADUATE)

The Innovative and Design Project is a practical, problem-solving-oriented research project that focuses on the development, design, implementation, or prototyping of a creative solution, product, system, or model. This type of project is suitable for students in non-education programmes who choose to work individually or in teams (maximum of five group members) and integrates theory with practical innovation.

6.3.1 Proposed Format for Innovative and Design Undergraduate Project

CHAPTER ONE: INTRODUCTION

1.0 Introduction

A short introduction summarizing the area of innovation and the practical problem being addressed.

1.1 Background of the Project

- Contextualize the practical problem or opportunity and explain why it deserves an innovative or design solution.

1.2 Statement of the Problem

- Present the specific problem that the design project seeks to address.

1.3 Purpose and Aims of the Project

- Explain the key purpose, broader goals, and what the project intends to accomplish.

1.4 Objectives of the Project

- List clear, measurable objectives that the design or innovation is intended to achieve.

1.5 Scope of the Design Project

- Define the boundaries of the project in terms of functions, features, and constraints.

1.6 Significance of the Project

- Discuss the expected impact or contributions of the design, including potential users, stakeholders, or communities impacted.

1.7 Definition of Key Terms

1.8 Organization of the Project

CHAPTER TWO: LITERATURE REVIEW

2.0 Introduction

- Restate the project focus and introduce the chapter.

2.1 Conceptual Review

- Discuss key conceptual and theoretical ideas that inform the project design.

2.2 Theoretical Review

- Discuss the theoretical ideas that inform the project design.

2.3 Review of Similar Innovations or Designs

- Review existing projects, products, or systems that relate to the innovation — showing gaps the current project seeks to fill.

2.4 Chapter Summary

- Summarise the key insights that inform the design decisions.

CHAPTER THREE: PROJECT DESIGN AND METHODOLOGY

3.0 Introduction

- Recap the aim of the chapter.

3.1 Design Approach and Rationale

- Describe the overall design philosophy, framework, or methodology used (e.g., iterative design, user-centred design).

3.2 System/Model Architecture or Framework

- Give a detailed description of the architecture, components, subsystems, or framework of the designed solution. Diagrams and flowcharts enhance clarity.

3.3 Materials, Tools, and Technologies Used

- List and explain the tools, software, platforms, or equipment used in the development or construction of the project.

3.4 Implementation/Development Procedures

- Explain the step-by-step processes involved in implementing the design or developing the prototype.

3.5 Testing and Validation

- Describe how the solution was tested, validated, or evaluated to ensure it works as expected.

3.6 Ethical Consideration (if any)

3.7 Chapter Summary

CHAPTER FOUR: RESULTS, EVALUATION AND DISCUSSION

4.0 Introduction

- Outline what this chapter covers.

4.1 Presentation of Results / Demonstration of Prototype

- Present the actual outcomes of the design process (screenshots, photographs, test outputs, interfaces, etc.).

4.2 Performance Evaluation

- Evaluate how the solution performs against objectives, criteria, or benchmarks.

4.3 Discussion of Results and Improvements

- Discuss what the results imply, including strengths, limitations, and how the design could be improved.

4.4 Chapter Summary

- A short conclusion to the chapter.

CHAPTER FIVE: SUMMARY, CONCLUSIONS AND RECOMMENDATIONS

5.0 Introduction

- Restate the broader context and focus of the chapter.

5.1 Summary of Key Developments and Outcomes

- Summarize what was achieved in the project by focusing on the design and implementation results.

5.2 Conclusions Drawn from the Project

- State what the findings mean in relation to the problem statement and objectives.

5.3 Recommendations

- Supply practical, actionable recommendations for users, future designers, industry relevance, or further research.

5.4 Lessons Learned and Reflections

- Brief reflection on what the team learned in the process, including teamwork, design challenges, and practical skills gained.

5.5 Chapter Summary

- A short conclusion to the chapter.

7.0 REFERENCES

All undergraduate project reports in the Faculty of Business Education (FBE) shall be written using the American Psychological Association (APA) referencing style, Seventh Edition (APA 7th). APA style is widely used in education, business, and social sciences and promotes clarity, consistency, and academic integrity. Students are required to acknowledge all sources cited in their work through in-text citations and a corresponding reference list at the end of the report.

7.1 In-Text Citations (APA Style)

In-text citations briefly identify the source of information within the body of the text. They must correspond exactly to the full reference in the reference list.

Basic Rules

- Include the author's surname and year of publication.
- Page numbers are required for direct quotations.

Examples

- One author: (Creswell, 2018)
- Two authors: (Saunders & Lewis, 2019)
- Three or more authors: (Gyimah et al., 2025; Akoto et al., 2026)
- Direct quotation: (Yin, 2018, p. 45)

Narrative citation (author mentioned in the sentence):

- Creswell (2018) explains that research design guides the choice of methods.

7.2 Writing the Reference List (APA Style)

The reference list appears at the end of the project report (after Chapter Five) and provides full details of all sources cited in the text.

General Rules

- Start on a new page titled References (bold and centered).
- Arrange entries alphabetically by the surname of the first author.
- Use hanging indentation (first line flush left, subsequent lines indented).
- Include only sources cited in the text.
- Use sentence case for titles (only the first word and proper nouns capitalized).

7.3 Common APA Reference Formats

7.3.1 Book

Author, A. A. (Year). *Title of the book*. Publisher.

Example:

Creswell, J. W. (2018). *Research design: Qualitative, quantitative, and mixed methods approaches*. SAGE Publications.

7.3.2 Journal Article

Author, A. A., & Author, B. B. (Year). Title of article. *Title of Journal*, volume(issue), pages.
<https://doi.org/xxxxx>

Example:

Akoto, E. O., Boateng, I., & Gyimah, P. (2026). Multi-Stage Strategic Approach to Reduce Academic Malpractices for Learning Effectiveness in African Higher Education Institutions. *Journal of Academic Ethics*, 24(1), 1-28. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10805-025-09678-0>

7.3.3 Website

Author/Organisation. (Year). Title of webpage. URL

Example:

Teacher Education in Sub-Saharan Africa (T-TEL). (2017). *National teachers' standards for Ghana*. <https://www.t-tel.org>

7.3.4 Thesis or Dissertation

Author, A. A. (Year). *Title of thesis* (Unpublished undergraduate project). University.

7.4 Important Notes for Students

- Every in-text citation must appear in the reference list, and every reference must be cited in the text.
- All references must be arranged in alphabetical order by the surname of the first author in accordance with APA (7th edition) guidelines.
- Do not mix APA with other styles (e.g. Harvard).
- Incorrect referencing may be treated as academic misconduct.

All students must use APA (7th edition) consistently throughout their undergraduate project. Supervisors shall guide students to ensure strict compliance with this referencing style.

8.0 APPENDICES

Appendices are used to present detailed, technical, or supplementary materials that support the undergraduate project but are not suitable for inclusion in the main body of the report. Including such materials in the appendices helps to maintain clarity and readability in the main text while allowing interested readers to consult additional information when necessary.

Materials that may be included as appendices include data collection instruments such as questionnaires, interview guides, observation checklists, and tests; detailed calculations; extended data tables; computer programme codes; technical diagrams; sample outputs; and other relevant supporting documents. In addition, appendices should include ethical clearance certificates or approval letters, plagiarism test or similarity reports, consent forms, and any official permissions obtained during the conduct of the study.

Appendices shall be placed immediately after the References section of the project report. Each appendix must begin on a new page and be clearly labelled using Roman numerals or capital letters, such as Appendix I, Appendix II, Appendix III, in the order in which they are referred to in the main text. All appendices should be properly titled and referenced within the report to guide the reader.

Students are expected to include only relevant materials in the appendices. The appendix section should support the study and provide evidence of ethical compliance and academic integrity, but it should not introduce new arguments, analysis, or discussion that belong in the main chapters.

9.0 FORMATTING GUIDELINES

To ensure uniformity, readability, and academic professionalism, all undergraduate project reports shall strictly adhere to the following formatting requirements. Students are expected to comply fully, and supervisors shall guide students to ensure strict adherence.

i. Numbering of Sections and Subsections

All chapters, sections, and subsections shall be numbered systematically. Numbering should not go beyond the third level, for example, 2.1.1. Tables, figures, charts, and formulas shall be numbered consecutively according to the chapter in which they appear.

ii. Line Spacing and Font Style

The entire project report, including references, shall be typed using double line spacing. The approved font type is Times New Roman, with a font size of 12 points throughout the document.

iii. Page Layout and Margins

The left margin shall be 3.75 cm to allow for binding, while the right, top, and bottom margins shall each be 2.5 cm. All text shall be fully justified. Footnotes, where necessary, shall be incorporated within the main text. Endnotes are not permitted.

iv. Paragraphing

Paragraphs may either be indented at the first line or blocked, depending on departmental preference. Consistency must be maintained throughout the document, and the text shall remain fully justified.

v. Footnotes

Footnotes should be used sparingly and only where absolutely necessary to clarify additional information.

vi. Pagination

Page numbering shall be placed at the bottom center of each page. Preliminary pages shall use Roman numerals, while the main body of the report shall use Arabic numerals.

vii. Headings and Levels

Chapter titles shall be centered, written in bold, and begin on a new page. Subheadings shall be clearly distinguished and numbered sequentially. Numbering of headings shall not exceed three levels to ensure clarity.

viii. Paper Size

All project reports shall be prepared on A4 paper size (8.27 × 11.29 inches). Students must ensure that document settings are adjusted accordingly.

ix. Tables, Figures, and Charts

Tables, figures, and charts shall be placed as close as possible to where they are first discussed in the text and must be clearly referred to in the main body of the report. All tables, figures, and charts shall be numbered serially from 1 in the order in which they appear in the document. The numbering shall be continuous throughout the report and shall not restart in each chapter. For example, Table 1, Table 2, Figure 1, Figure 2, Chart 1, Chart 2. Table numbers and titles shall appear above the table and be written in bold, while figure and chart numbers and captions shall appear below the figure or chart and also be written in bold. Titles and captions must be clear, concise, and descriptive of the content presented.

Tables shall strictly follow the three-line table format, consisting of two horizontal lines at the top (one above and one below the column headings) and one horizontal line at the bottom of the table. Vertical lines shall not be used in tables under any circumstance, and tables, figures, or charts shall not be enclosed in border lines. Where a table, figure, or chart extends onto another page, this shall be clearly indicated, for example, "Table 2 continued." Every table, figure, and chart included in the report must be explained or discussed in the text to show its relevance to the study.

x. Formulae and Equations

Formulas shall be centered on a new line and numbered consecutively by chapter. Long equations may be broken at appropriate mathematical operators. All symbols and quantities should be clearly defined.

xi. Plagiarism Check

All undergraduate project reports must undergo a plagiarism or similarity check before final submission. A similarity index of not more than 20% is recommended. Supervisors shall ensure that plagiarism reports are reviewed before approving final submission.

10.0 PRINTING AND SUBMISSION REQUIREMENTS

All undergraduate project reports submitted in partial fulfilment of the requirements for the award of a bachelor's degree at AAMUSTED shall comply strictly with the approved printing and submission requirements outlined in this section. These requirements are intended to ensure uniformity, durability, and proper archiving of undergraduate research work.

Undergraduate project reports shall be hard-bound using a black cover only. No other cover colour shall be accepted for undergraduate project work. The black cover shall contain all approved cover-page details as specified in the formatting guidelines.

Each undergraduate student is required to print and submit two (2) hard-bound copies of the final, supervisor-approved project report to the Department or Faculty for assessment and record purposes. These copies must be identical in content and format.

In addition to the printed copies, the Faculty or Department shall establish an approved electronic submission platform through which students shall submit a third copy of the project report in electronic format (PDF). The electronic copy shall serve purposes of documentation, archiving, quality assurance, and future reference. Students are required to ensure that the electronic version submitted is the same as the final printed version.

Supervisors shall guide students to comply fully with these printing and submission requirements and shall verify that all submitted copies meet the approved undergraduate standards before final acceptance.

11.0 FURTHER READINGS

- Creswell, J. W., & Creswell, J. D. (2018). *Research design: Qualitative, quantitative, and mixed methods approaches* (5th ed.). SAGE Publications.
- Healey, M., & Jenkins, A. (2009). *Developing undergraduate research and inquiry*. Higher Education Academy.
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- Ministry of Education (MoE). (2017). *National teachers' standards for Ghana: Guidelines*. Government of Ghana.
- Saunders, M., Lewis, P., & Thornhill, A. (2019). *Research methods for business students* (8th ed.). Pearson Education.
- Teacher Education in Sub-Saharan Africa (T-TEL). (2016). *Professional development framework for teacher education in Ghana*. Government of Ghana.